only people with teachers' certificates could participate in classroom functions.

I thought it was ridiculous that a parent couldn't assist in school and arranged for the rule to be changed. Later on, as an outgrowth of this, California became a national pioneer in a program that enlisted the help of parents in the early education of their children. Although our efforts to "squeeze, cut, and trim" reduced the state's rate of spending substantially, we had had only six months to close the deficit before the new fiscal year, and I realized this wasn't going to be long enough to deal with the fiscal mess left by the Brown administration.

We hired a team of independent auditors who documented for the people how bad the mess was, and then I went on television and said I had no choice but to ask for a tax increase.

It was not an enjoyable speech to make. I'd campaigned on a promise to keep the lid on taxes, now I was asking for an increase. But I swallowed hard and said that as soon as I could, I'd make sure we gave the people some of their money back to them.

Over the next eight years, we did just that four times, but that's getting ahead of my story.